



**BLUE RIDGE COMMUNITY COLLEGE
BOARD OF TRUSTEES MEETING MINUTES**

May 8, 2023 ~ 5 p.m.

Henderson County Campus, Patton Building, Workforce Development Board Room (#120)

Item

MEMBERS PRESENT	Vivian Bolaños, Brianna Allen, Cathy Childress, Steve Dozier, Dr. Clay Eddleman, Betty Gash, Dr. Jeremy Gibbs, Chip Gould, Nathan Kennedy, Kelly Leonard, Mike Pressley, Jim Rasmussen, Dr. Brian Weaver and Duke Woodhull
MEMBERS ABSENT	Mark Isabelli
OTHERS PRESENT	Lisa Adkins, Kathy Allen, Carolyn Alley, Lorri Allison, Kirsten Bunch, Ginny Hamson, Dr. Laura Leatherwood, Dr. Chad Merrill, Tammy Pryor, Dr. Scott Queen, Ben Rickert, Dr. David Stegall, Steve Young, Faculty Senate members Rose Fichera-Lening and Carol Wheeler, UNC Health Pardee CEO Jay Kirby and College Attorney Dean Shatley
CALL TO ORDER AND WELCOME	Chairman Chip Gould called the meeting to order at approximately 5 p.m.
SPECIAL RECOGNITIONS	Dr. Leatherwood introduced several guests including Mr. Kirby, then recognized: • Mr. Chip Gould – recipient of the Governor’s Volunteer Service Award; Mr. Kirby also provided remarks • Dr. Jeremy Gibbs – Board service from 2014-2023 • Mr. Duke Woodhull – Board service from 2013-2023 • Ms. Brianna Allen – SGA President and Board Service since 2021; graduating on May 13 • Ms. Lisa Adkins – VP of Advancement/Foundation Executive Director; leaving the College on May 18
ETHICS STATEMENT	Mr. Gould read the Ethics Statement. No conflicts were reported.
APPROVAL OF AGENDA	Ms. Bolaños moved to approve the meeting agenda. The motion was seconded by Mr. Rasmussen and carried without opposition.
APPROVAL OF CONSENT AGENDA	As the document for the Perkins Allotment (item d on the consent agenda) had not been received by the College prior to the meeting, it was removed from the consent agenda. A motion was made by Mr. Leonard, seconded by

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Ms. Bolaños, to approve the consent agenda with the noted change. The motion passed without opposition.

Finance and Investment Committee

Committee Chairman Kelly Leonard requested approval of the minutes from the April 25, 2023, Finance and Facilities joint committees meeting from members of either committee. On a motion by Mr. Kennedy, seconded by Mr. Pressley, the minutes were approved. There was no opposition.

By direction from the Finance Committee, Committee Chairman Kelly Leonard made the following motions:

- To approve the write-off of delinquent accounts receivable
- To approve the resolution authorizing payment of normal operating expenses for 2023-2024
- To approve the President's Blanket Travel authorization for 2023-2024

As the motions came from the Finance Committee, no second was needed. All of the motions passed without opposition.

COLLEGE REPORTS

President's Report

Dr. Leatherwood referenced her written report which was published on the meeting web page, pausing for any related questions. She covered several topics in her verbal report including:

- Expanded use of the consent agenda; reminder to review prior to meetings
- Graduation on May 13; largest graduating class in College history
- Foundation Transition Plan
 - Position has been realigned and posted as Executive Director of Foundation rather than VP of Advancement
 - Dr. Stegall is serving as interim Executive Director
 - Dr. Stegall will be responsible for Marketing going forward so that the new Executive Director can focus on fundraising for the College
- New Community College System President
 - Dr. Jeff Cox will lead the System effective June 1, 2023
 - As Vice President of the NCACCP (President's Association), now serving as acting president upon Dr. Cox's resignation as president
- Legislative Activity
 - Closely following the NC House and Senate this biennial session, especially these bills:

- Senate Bill 692 – authority of the State Board of CC and the President of the NC Community College System
- House Bill 715 – modernize, restructure and evaluate the UNC System and the NC Community College System
- Senate Bill 680 - reaccreditation
- Contract signed with Cooper Construction
 - Reporting in accordance with College Procedure 5.6.5
 - Signed contract for \$55,000 with Cooper Construction to remove and replace soffit on Innovative High School Building
 - Emergency repair for life, health, safety reasons
 - Available County funds will cover the project cost; expect project to be completed by June 30, 2023

Educational Foundation Report

Vice President Adkins was recognized by the Board Chairman for an update from the Advancement Division.

- Ms. Adkins shared that marketing efforts are currently focused in these areas:
 - Summer courses
 - Special features on graduates and graduation
 - Free college
 - New programs for fall
- Foundation staff is spending time on:
 - Three new grant applications
 - End of fiscal year tasks
 - Budget
 - Audit preparations

Student Government Association (SGA) Report

Outgoing SGA President Brianna Allen delivered her last SGA update to the Trustees prior to her graduation on May 13, highlighting recent SGA activities on all campuses.

OLD BUSINESS

Mr. Gould shared that since the last Board meeting, the Blue Ridge Community College (BRCC) Strategic Planning Committee, established and managed by Transylvania County Commissioners, held their first meeting. The next meeting has been scheduled for May 15 and monthly meetings are planned thereafter.

NEW BUSINESS

Mr. Gould called on Dr. Leatherwood to share the results of the annual Board Self-Evaluation survey. Dr. Leatherwood relayed that in all but one of the nine categories ranked in the survey, the ratings were either “strongly agree” or

	"agree." The category with the exception was "Effectiveness in Transylvania County." She and Mr. Gould expressed their optimism that the newly established BRCC Strategic Planning Committee (see old business) is a step forward and a path toward improvement.
CLOSED SESSION	The Blue Ridge Community College Board of Trustees entered closed session on a motion pursuant to G.S. 143-318.11(a)(1), to prevent the disclosure of confidential personnel information pursuant to G.S. 115D-27, and 318.11(a)(3), to prevent disclosure of confidential attorney-client communications. The motion was made by Ms. Bolaños, seconded by Mr. Woodhull, and passed without opposition.
	Motion to adjourn closed session and move back into open session was made by Mr. Kennedy and seconded by Mr. Dozier. Motion passed.
COMMENTS AND ADJOURNMENT	Dr. Gibbs moved to adopt the President's Evaluation Committee recommendations as presented and discussed in closed session. Coming from committee, this motion did not require a second. The Chair called for a vote on the motion. Motion adopted unanimously. Dr. Leatherwood rejoined the meeting. Dr. Gibbs informed Dr. Leatherwood that the Board adopted the committee's recommendations and thanked her for her service and commitment to the College. Other Board members commented and thanked Dr. Leatherwood, as well. The Chair announced that the next meeting of the Board of Trustees is July 10, 2023, at 11:30 a.m. He also reminded Trustees of the upcoming graduation this weekend. The Chair asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. Dr. Gibbs moved to adjourn; seconded by Ms. Bolanos. Motion approved. The Chair adjourned the meeting at approximately 6:30 p.m.

John B. "Chip" Gould, Chairman

Dr. Laura B. Leatherwood, Secretary